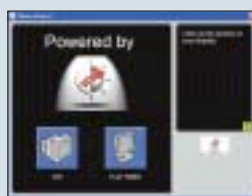


Whites, whiter; Colours Brighter

Most people don't know that normal brightness and contrast settings are not optimised for games. In fact, 3D games require different settings altogether to give the same graphical effect that the designers intended. For example, you might miss an essential item because your screen was too dark, or you might not be able to see an opponent in time for you to take action. This is where 3Deep comes in. By adjusting your gamma and colour settings to work with games that support it, you can get the best possible output from your monitor.

Using 3Deep is a very simple process. The moment you've finished installing the program, a calibration wizard pops up and guides you through the process. We used Sony's SDM-N80 19-inch LCD display for our workshop.

There are seven steps to calibrating the display, the first step is choosing the kind of display you use. The angle at which you view the LCD screen is very important.



this is done, the software will determine the actual contrast level, in order to set the optimal view distance for your display.

In the next three steps, you need to set the optimal levels for each colour component of your display—red, blue and green. This is the most important part of the test, as things can go awry if not done carefully. Take your time in deciding the exact point at



Now, you have to set the elevation and angle of the screen to what you normally use. Once

which the intensity of the middle strip equals the background.

Finally, in the last step, you can do some extra tweaking to get exactly what you want. Keep an eye out for the 'Before\After' section to view the results of your setting. Clicking on the 'Set Game Gamma' button will apply the results. This button also forces



games that don't support 3Deep to accept the calibration settings that you've chosen.

Remember, it's a good idea to rerun the program every once in a while, especially if you change your resolution, bit depth, or your entire display. Have fun beating the bad guys!

though it performed exceedingly well in the resolution test its horizontal bar resolution was average. The Samsung Syncmaster 152S stood third because of its average performance in the horizontal and vertical bar resolution test. The Acer AL511's performance was way below average in all the subtests.

Moving to the 17-inch category, the BenQ FP767 stood first, as its performance was simply outstanding in the resolution test. The LG Flatron 1710B stood second because of its below average performance in the Horizontal and Vertical Bar Resolution tests. The Samsung Syncmaster 171s stood third due to a reasonably poor performance in the horizontal bar resolution test. The Philips 170B4 MG performance was just not acceptable in any of the subtests

and stood dead last.

When it comes to Colour and Grayscale, the Acer AL511 stood first as it aced the three subtests, with no visible streaking or ghosting. The Sharp LL-T15G3 came close, but lost out by a margin of 0.25 points.

The HCL HCM 500 SLA's performance was disappointing, as there was lot of ghosting and streaking visible, and its performance in the White and Black Level shift was mediocre.

The LG Flatron 1710B won the 17-inch category, with a good performance in the white and black level shift. For the second place, it was a tie between the Samsung Syncmaster 171S and the Sony SDM-S71. The Philips 170 B4 MG's performance in this test was way below average.

In the Miscellaneous tests, the Samsung Syncmaster 151 MP got the maximum score as the screen was uniform throughout and there was absolutely no flicker. The Philips 150 MT came close by standing second as its performance in the Screen Uniformity test was average. CMV1512 put on a valiant fight but lost the second position just by 0.25 marks and came third. The Philips 150 P4 AB performance was disappointing as one could notice dark and light regions on the screen.

In the 17-inch category Samsung Syncmaster171s performed quite well hence stood first. The Sony SDM S-71 also performed quite well and came in second. The Acer AL 712 and Samsung Syncmaster 171 MP both performed poorly and stood last.



Philips 170 B4 MG

- + Convertable from landscape to portrait; wall mountable; In-built in speakers
- Poor performance



Samsung 171MP

- + Sleek looking; TV tuner
- Low luminance; Very expensive



Samsung Syncmaster 171S

- + Good performance; Convertable from landscape to portrait; Wall mountable
- No in-built speakers



Sony SDM-S71

- + Good performance
- Low on features



Viewsonic VG700

- + Good feature set
- Low refresh rate; Average performance